

Worshiping in Spirit and Truth Until Truth Becomes Capacity

Why don't we go to Romans 8, and I will pass in review. We are not going to be real long, and those are not famous last words. Those are instructions.

Thank You, Jesus.

In John 4, Jesus told the Samaritan woman:

"The hour cometh, and now is,
when the true worshippers shall worship the Father
in spirit and in truth:
for the Father seeketh such to worship him.
God is a Spirit:
and they that worship him must worship him
in spirit and in truth."

We found out that when He said "in spirit and in truth," He was talking about positional truth. He said, "The hour is coming and now is." On the millennial time clock, one hour is forty-one point something years. Jesus was simply speaking of the generation His feet were on this planet.

He was saying, "The hour is here, Samaritan woman, when true worshipers are going to worship the Father in spirit and in truth."

When He said "in spirit," He was not talking about starting out in the flesh in a slow service and ending up in the Spirit. He was talking about a positional truth. Old Testament saints could not give Him this. You can, because it is in spirit: from the recesses of that wellspring He talked about in the same chapter, from your born-again spirit, with the nature that made you a partaker of His divine nature.

Now you can finally crawl up in His lap with a nature like His and fellowship with Him in a fellowship He waited for four thousand years to have.

When He said the Father was seeking such to worship Him, He was not hopping from church to church looking for a good worship team. He waited out the dispensation, those four thousand years, for the first men to be born spiritually alive on this planet, starting with Jesus, who could fellowship with Him once again in the fellowship He lost when Adam fell to spiritual death.

He said, "Listen, Samaritan woman, the hour is this generation. I am going to die. When you believe on Me, you will be quickened together with Me in My death. Then you will be quickened together in My resurrection, and you will receive a nature like Mine. You will be a true worshiper

who can worship Me in the spirit, in the born-again recesses of the human spirit, and in truth."

Both of them are positional truths.

These two, spirit and truth, are power twins. They are just like what we found when we broke down fasting and came to, "This kind cometh not out but by prayer and fasting." Prayer and fasting are power twins, but so are worshiping in spirit and in truth.

Why? Because both of them deal with positional truth.

Old Testament saints could not give Him this. You can. This is what Hebrews 1 was heralding when it says Jesus obtained a more excellent inheritance than the angels and, by inheritance, a more excellent name.

To which of the angels did He ever say, "Thou art My Son; this day have I begotten Thee"?

To the angels He said, "Who maketh His angels spirits, and His ministers a flame of fire." But to the Son He said, "This day You are My Son. You were born from Me."

Angels were created on the outside of God. They were created full grown for full service. You were born from the inside of God. You are sons and daughters. Only you, as family, can give Him what He can get from no other creation.

So why hang around?

"Brother Roberson, you have yelled enough about worshiping in spirit."

I know. But He is talking about a positional truth. He is not talking about starting in the flesh and somewhere along in the service ending up in the Spirit. He is talking about a positional truth.

Whether you feel up or down, fallen or risen, mean, ugly, or nice, when you start worshiping Him, you are worshiping Him in spirit. It is not a place you attain to. It is a positional truth. You can now give Him what He has longed for.

And if you will stay in when it is hard, when you feel ugly, mean, despondent, and like giving up, but you will not quit telling Him how much you love Him, then you are going to end up on the other side. If you stay in there, you will end up living there.

My emotions are strong. Yes, they are. They are a worthy foe, and they are strong, but they are not strong enough.

When Paul talked about the death nature, he said:

"The good that I would I do not:
but the evil which I would not,
that I do."

So it is no longer I that do it, but sin that dwelleth in me.

He was saying, "With my mind I received the law. I wanted to keep it. I wanted to do what God said. But there was another law working in my members. The good I wanted to do, I could not end up doing. The evil I tried to refuse, that is what I ended up doing. So it is no longer I, but the old nature that dwelleth in me."

If we are going to understand what it means to worship Him in spirit and in truth, we have to understand that Old Testament saints could not worship Him in the same kind of truth that you can. They had death natures and no capacity to understand truth in the capacity you have.

The power twins of prayer and fasting, and the worship twins of spirit and truth, carry the same kind of force. One complements and activates the other.

This is the part I did not understand: if I ever really learn to worship Him in spirit, it will not be long before I am worshiping Him in truth.

What do I mean? I now have a capacity to worship Him in truth because I have a nature that has been made a partaker of His divine nature. I can understand what God is like. Since I have a capacity for truth, I can worship Him in truth. I can understand Him with that truth.

If I can understand truth, then I have a capacity to increase that truth, the understanding of it, and the power of it by continuing to become more like Him through the power twin of worship.

Am I excited? Yes.

To worship Him in spirit is truth to me. The Old Testament saints could not, but you can, because you have a nature He can fellowship with. Even more than that, you have a capacity for truth.

The Old Testament saints could only dream about that. Their reference to the law, in the heart of the law, was the Ten Commandments, and they could not keep them. That is why there was animal sacrifice. If they could have kept the law, they would not have needed animal sacrifice, and Jesus would not have had to come. But they could not keep it.

So Paul described their condition:

"O wretched man that I am!
who shall deliver me from the body of this death?"

Then he answered his own question:

"I thank God through Jesus Christ our Lord."

Where an old sin nature used to order my mind and make me walk after it, it cannot do that anymore because it is not strong enough. Emotions are not strong enough. Now I have a new nature that is taking the seat over my mind and ordering my footsteps, because I have a capacity not only to understand truth but to walk in it.

If I can understand truth, it can be magnified.

How is it magnified? By fellowshiping with Him in spirit through worship. Truth is magnified until you belong to that elite club where all things are possible to him that believes, because nobody could stop you from believing and growing in the truth of who He said He is.

Let me show you something in Romans 8. Look very closely at verse 9:

"But ye are not in the flesh,
but in the Spirit,
if so be that the Spirit of God dwell in you.
Now if any man have not the Spirit of Christ,
he is none of his."

What qualifies me not to be in the flesh? What qualifies me to be in the Spirit? He says, "If so be that the Spirit of God dwell in you." Then He tells you what it is: "If any man have not the Spirit of Christ, he is none of His."

This verse is talking about a positional truth. Follow me closely, and you will get so free you will hardly be able to stand yourself.

Most of the time we think He is talking about the Holy Spirit here, but He answers His own question in the verse. The translators had to decide whether spirit referred to the Spirit of God or the spirit of man by the context of the verse and chapter.

He says, "You are not in the flesh, but in the Spirit." What qualifies me to be in the Spirit? "If so be that the Spirit of God dwell in you." Then He says, "If any man have not the Spirit of Christ, he is none of His."

Some people wonder, because verse 10 says, "If Christ be in you." They ask, "Do I have the Spirit of Christ? Do I have the Holy Spirit? Do I have my born-again human spirit?"

You do have the Spirit of Christ, but a little short Jesus did not step into you and walk around independently of your born-again spirit.

Let me tell you what the Spirit of Christ is.

You used to have the spirit of Adam. Did you have Adam's personal human spirit? No. What did you have that was his? You had the nature he fell to. By one man sin entered the world, and death by sin. In that one man's transgression, all sinned. You did not have Adam's personal human spirit, but you did have the death you inherited from him.

Now I have the Spirit of Christ. Do I have His personal human spirit? No. What do I have? I have the life in me that I inherited from Him. That is the Spirit of Christ.

The Spirit of Christ is the born-again human spirit you received when you were translated out of darkness into the kingdom of His dear Son.

When Romans 8:9 says, "You are not in the flesh, but in the Spirit," He is not talking about a bad-hair day. He is talking about a positional truth. You are not in the flesh, but in the Spirit, if this born-again spirit dwells in you.

That means you are in the Spirit. You were taken out of the world into the Spirit. You are not walking according to the flesh anymore. You are in the Spirit as a positional truth.

Even if you are having a bad day and everything is going wrong, you are still not in the flesh. You are in the Spirit, because He is talking about positional truth. He clarifies it: if any man does not have the Spirit of Christ, he is none of His.

Every time Romans 8 says "walk not after the flesh, but after the Spirit," walking after the flesh means the Jew who was not born again, who received the Ten Commandments and could not keep them. They tried to walk according to those commandments, and the good they tried to do, they could not do.

That is why, when Paul graduated to Romans 8, the first thing he said was:

"There is therefore now no condemnation
to them which are in Christ Jesus,
who walk not after the flesh,
but after the Spirit."

What kind of condemnation was he talking about? The condemnation of the Jew who received the law and could not keep it. The harder they tried, the less they could keep it. It ended up condemning them.

Romans 7 and Romans 8 are one thought. Look at Romans 7:5:

"For when we were in the flesh,
the motions of sins,
which were by the law,
did work in our members
to bring forth fruit unto death."

What did Romans 8:9 say? "You are not in the flesh, but in the Spirit."

Why? Because I have been born again. My old nature is not controlling me or my mind anymore.

When you were in the flesh, the motions of sin, sin in the direction it took when it was on the move, were set off by the law. When the law said, "You shall not covet," sin went in that direction and worked covetousness, producing death.

Then Romans 7:6 says:

"But now we are delivered from the law,
that being dead wherein we were held;
that we should serve in newness of spirit,
and not in the oldness of the letter."

When Paul speaks of the law here, he is speaking of the heart of the law, the Ten Commandments. There was a whole Levitical priesthood set up because they were spiritually dead and could not keep this law. Animals were slaughtered in their place.

Not you.

Now we are delivered from the law. The old man and its sin nature, the thing the law was holding onto and producing this dilemma with, suddenly died, and a new creation stood up in its place. Now we serve in newness of spirit, not in oldness of the letter.

So Paul says in verse 7:

"What shall we say then?
Is the law sin?
God forbid."

No. He would not even have known sin, because he was born spiritually dead and it was his nature, except the law said, "Stop." He said, "I could not."

But in Romans 8, he is talking about when he got free. You are no longer in the flesh but in the Spirit, if this born-again spirit dwells in you. If any man does not have this, he is none of His.

Since you have been born again, you can worship Him from the confines of your born-again human spirit, and you have a capacity for truth that Old Testament saints could only dream of. They had a death nature and could not even keep the Ten Commandments.

Not you.

You have a capacity for truth, and a capacity for truth to become part of you while you become part of it. You can keep increasing in what God said and believing what He said until nothing is impossible to you.

Through what power twin? Private worship, which magnifies the presence, the reservoir, and the love of God and causes truth to be amplified in you.

Can I prove that a little further? Go to 2 Corinthians 3. Let us start with verse 6:

"Who also hath made us able ministers of the new testament;
not of the letter,
but of the spirit:
for the letter killeth,
but the spirit giveth life."

We are not talking here about beating somebody to death with the knowledge of righteousness until they say, "Quit telling me to stop sinning. Do not put me under law. I am under grace." That is not what he is talking about.

He is talking about being a minister of the New Testament, the New Covenant, of the new nature. The letter that kills is the kind of law under Romans 7 delivered to the Jew who could not keep it.

Paul kept coming back to this subject, and I, for one, am glad he did.

Then verse 7 says:

"But if the ministration of death,
written and engraven in stones,
was glorious..."

How clear do you want it? He called the Ten Commandments, when given to spiritually dead man, the ministration of death.

If the ministration of death, written and engraved in stones, was glorious so that the children of Israel could not behold the face of Moses for the glory of his countenance, which glory was to be done away, how shall not the ministration of the Spirit be more glorious?

Verse 9:

"For if the ministration of condemnation be glory,
much more doth the ministration of righteousness
exceed in glory."

Those Old Testament saints had glory, but what you walk in brings accountability. What are you going to do with it?

I should not ask you that. You are the crowd here worshiping for four hours. Wise ones, I salute you.

Verse 10 says:

"For even that which was made glorious
had no glory in this respect,
by reason of the glory that excelleth."

That which was done away was glorious, but much more, that which remains is glorious.

Seeing then that we have such hope, we use great plainness of speech. We are not like Moses, who put a veil over his face so the children of Israel could not look steadfastly to the end of what was abolished.

That veil was a type of spiritual death. Beneath that spiritual death was a type of the rebirth on Moses' face, but they could not see past the veil because of spiritual death. They could not see into the revelation. They could not understand it.

Even though they looked at the shadow, the type of the rebirth in the glory of Moses' face, there was a veil of spiritual death over it. They could not look into it, operate in it, or understand it.

How do you know it means that? Hang on until we get to the end.

Paul says their minds were blinded, and until this day the same veil remains untaken away in the reading of the Old Testament, which veil is done away in Christ.

So was the veil spiritual death that kept them from walking in the glory of the rebirth? Yes.

Verse 15 says:

"But even unto this day,
when Moses is read,
the veil is upon their heart.
Nevertheless when it shall turn to the Lord,
the veil shall be taken away."

Now the Lord is that spirit, and where the spirit of the Lord is, there is liberty.

We have used that verse out of context. We have thought of the Holy Ghost flowing into a service, someone dancing, someone running, and then somebody says, "Where the Spirit of the Lord is, there is liberty." And yes, liberty is definitely fruit of where the Holy Ghost is.

But that is not what this verse is talking about.

He is talking about the veil being taken away. These people are born again, and where the Spirit of the Lord is, there is liberty: the liberty of a new nature, freedom from the condemnation of sin, and for the Jew, freedom from the dilemma, "The good I would do, I cannot."

How do you know He means the veil? Look at the last verse of 2 Corinthians 3:

"But we all,
with open face
beholding as in a glass
the glory of the Lord,
are changed into the same image
from glory to glory,
even as by the Spirit of the Lord."

"We all" means all of us now in this dispensation. With open face means you do not have a veil of spiritual death over your eyes. We are beholding as in a mirror the glory of the Lord, and because we can see Him, we are changed into the same image from glory to glory.

He did not change the subject. Go to 2 Corinthians 4:6:

"For God,
who commanded the light to shine out of darkness,
hath shined in our hearts,
to give the light of the knowledge of the glory of God
in the face of Jesus Christ."

What kind of darkness? Spiritual death.

God has shined in our hearts to give the light of the knowledge of God from staring into the face of the Lord Jesus Christ, in whom you are being conformed from glory to glory because you have no more veil of spiritual death over your face.

So when Jesus said to worship Him in spirit and in truth, He meant that because you have His nature, you can finally give Him the fellowship He longed for. But you have more than that. You have a capacity to understand truth, operate in it, let it become part of you, and become part of it.

Your understanding can become so prominent that you take your place with those few in history who changed their generation, those to whom all things are possible.

Now, do you think you have time to worship tonight?

Think of the duck egg in the hen's nest. Baby Huey got near the water, and Mama Hen screamed at him, "Whatever possessed you, Baby Huey? You could have drowned out there!"

He said, "I do not know, but there must be some truth that belongs to me, because I had a capacity that came from somewhere to understand that I could swim. I am sorry I had to leave my chicken mama on the bank, but I obviously am not a chicken. I must be something else, because I have a nature that is teaching me truth. I can swim."

That is where the edge comes: to believe and understand truth because you have a capacity to understand it.

Now you have invited Him in, in a baptism of your spirit that flows over into your soul and then permeates the geographical area you are walking in, until truth comes alive in you.

You are a devastating, generation-changing machine.

You can swim.

I am going to encourage you again to worship with Him. What you are really lacking, and what you need to break into, is private worship.

Private worship is going to change the whole world.

I used to think it belonged only to worship leaders. Not so. Look what it did to my understanding, my teaching gift, my preaching gift, and the anointing I walk in when I go into a hospital room, pick up a telephone, or send a cloth out.

I have just barely begun the geographical baptism of presence that Smith Wigglesworth enjoyed, when a man could walk past his chair, fall down, and say, "God, man, you convict me," and repent.

Once you nail private worship down, it will be easy to be a partaker of everything else as truth. You will not come here waiting for someone to pump you up. You will have the eye of the tiger.

Stand up.

Come back up, worship people, for at least two songs. Lift your hands. The evening is ours. Ten o'clock is the official time. I may get back up ten minutes till. We will do a worship song together again and see what He did inside us while we spent a couple of hours with Him in private worship, or at least an hour and a half.

I magnify and glorify You. Hallelujah, hallelujah, hallelujah. Blessed be the day You saved me. I magnify, glorify, and bless You.

Father, thank You, thank You, thank You. Blessed be the day I could call You Abba. Oh, how I worship You, glorify You, praise You, and magnify You.

Unashamedly, unrestrainedly, unequivocally, I lift my hands and worship You. I glorify You and magnify You with all my heart. With all my heart, I tell You I love You.

It is not the wording of your statements, the theological essence, or the perfect extras. It is how much of your heart you can pour in.

Come on. Hallelujah.

If you are spending five or six hours, your mind may trail off and wander, but the law of confession will kick in. Eventually saying you love Him over and over will pull you back. But when you only have an hour and a half left, you need to bring yourself back and worship Him spirit, soul, and

body, not just with lip service.

Grab yourself. Pull yourself together. Tell your body, your spirit, and your soul that you are in the presence of a King, and you will not do Him disservice by wandering down the street while your lips are telling Him you love Him.

Practice it for a little while. Learn how to do it.

From this point on, if you want to walk, get on your face, sit down, whatever you want to do, do it.

Hallelujah, Jesus. I love You. I glorify and magnify You. Blessed be the day I could call You my Lord and my Savior. I am not ashamed of You. I say it with all my heart: I love You.

I want all creation to know I love You, Jesus. I love You.

If I cannot keep saying that because there is something in the way that will hardly let me love You, I will beat it to death. I will keep telling You how much I love You until it turns into a liquid state and leaves.

Hallelujah, Jesus. I worship You. I magnify and glorify You.

Once in a while, your feelings shoot through you in a quickening. That means you got on a road you can follow. Sometimes when you say "hallelujah" four or five times, you feel a quickening and it causes you to jump inside. That is a good trail to stay on.

This is not vain repetition. He would not have said vain repetition if there was no repetition that was not vain.

You cannot tell Him how much you love Him enough. It will not be classified as vain. You cannot do it.

If the devil tries to pull this one on you, "Which One do I worship, the Father or the Son?" I will tell you what Jesus said. The Father judges no man, but has committed all judgment to the Son, that all men should honor the Son even as they honor the Father. He that honors the Son honors the Father.

When you are honoring the Son in pure, unadulterated worship, you are honoring the Father. When you are honoring the Father in pure, unadulterated worship, you are honoring the Son.

It does not matter how long you give each One. You can give days to One or the Other, and you are honoring the Father and honoring the Son. You can give a lifetime to One or the Other, and you have honored the Father and the Son.

Do not let the devil mix you up. Just tell Him how much you love Him. You will get there.

Hallelujah. I glorify and magnify You.

Does it matter how softly you do it? Does it matter if you whisper? Does it matter if you yell? It is not the whispering and it is not the yelling. It is how much you pour yourself into the words you say.

I love You. I glorify You. I magnify You.

It is not talking fast. It is not talking slow. It is filling your statements with adoration. It will not be long before you hit a baptism of the mind. It will just gush out of you, and they will have to make you quit. You will not want to stop.

Come on. The flesh is worthy to fight past. It is worthy, and it will fight you, but you are stronger.

You may burst out in tongues, and that is all right, but this time is designated for worship. Pull yourself back into worship. You may burst out again, but try to spend all you can in worship. We will have seasons of praying in tongues. Do it at home. Do it when you are driving. This is worship.

There will be a day when there will be a group of people around you, and you will say "hallelujah," and they will fall down. They will say, "My God, you know how to testify."

You have that right.

Diseases and devils will cry and leave. Why? Because you can worship Him in truth. Truth will become you, and you will become truth. All things will be possible to him who believes, because there is no limitation to the magnification, understanding, and capacity you have for truth.

Hallelujah, Jesus. I love You and glorify You.

I want to tell You, I love You. I am not ashamed. I am not ashamed of the gospel of Jesus Christ. I am not ashamed.

Say it again: Hallelujah.

How about glory? Glory, glory, glory. Since God's name is Yah, hallelujah. Say it ten thousand times. It is one statement: I love You. I worship You.

You are not a man that You can lie. I have what I say. I call myself dead so I can separate to You all the glory and the praise.

Hallelujah. Glory, glory, glory. I magnify You, glorify You, and exalt You. I love You. I want to glorify You.